

Rohit Sharma's men must navigate fine margins to conquer final frontier

The series is India's second in the 2023-2025 cycle of the World Test Championship, after the two-Test series in West Indies in July.

P. K. Ajith Kumar
ajithkumar.pk@thehindu.co.in

Thirty-one years have passed since Jimmy Cook edged Kapil Dev's outswinger to Sachin Tendulkar at slip and reluctantly walked back to the dressing room at the Kingsmead Cricket Ground in Durban.

It was no ordinary ball. It was history.

That was the first ball in international cricket in South Africa since 1970; there had been an ICC ban on the country because of its apartheid policy. Cook believed the ball hadn't carried, but the square-leg umpire thought otherwise and advised his colleague accordingly (ironically, this was the first match in which television replays were being used, though only for line calls).

More drama followed in India's first-ever Test against South Africa, which ended in a draw after the rain washed away an entire day's play. Pravin Amre made an

Righting the wrong: Rohit Sharma was ruled out of the Test leg of India's last tour of South Africa with an injury. He would hope to make amends this time as an opener and captain.

GETTYIMAGES

excellent hundred on debut after coming in at 38 for four. **The host, however, went on to win the four-match series 1-0, riding on the nine-wicket victory in the third Test at Gqeberha.**

Three decades later, India's quest for a series victory in South Africa

